CROCHET PATTERN

# Poinsettia

## *Table Runner*



AI preview image

A lush Christmas runner: three large three-layer red poinsettias and three ivory poinsettias on a bed of dark green leaves, green and gold ferns, red berries and gold bead sprigs. Every piece is sewn onto a hidden crochet spine.

ENGLISH · US CROCHET TERMS

DESIGNFRSHOP

# Poinsettia Table Runner

| | |
|---|---|
| SKILL LEVEL | Intermediate (many small pieces, simple stitches) |
| FINISHED SIZE | about 40 × 117 cm (15½ × 46 in), measured over the leaf tips |
| FLOWERS | 3 large red (about 25 cm across) + 3 ivory (about 16 cm across) |
| TIME | about 38–51 hours, plus drying time |

## Materials

DK / light worsted (CYC 3) cotton or cotton blend. Amounts include about 20 % extra; balls are counted at 120 m per 50 g.

| COLOUR | LENGTH | 50 G BALLS | USED FOR |
|---|---|---|---|
| Christmas red | 410 m | 4 | middle + inner bracts, rings, berries |
| Burgundy | 205 m | 2 | back bracts, back rings, berry stems |
| Ivory / cream | 160 m | 2 | ivory flowers |
| Dark green | 350 m | 3 | spine, leaves, dark ferns |
| Olive green | 110 m | 1 | olive ferns |
| Antique gold | 165 m | 2 | gold ferns |

- Crochet hook 3.5 mm (US E/4); tapestry needle; sewing needle; stitch markers; rust-proof pins; scissors
- 75 gold beads, 6–8 mm: 48 for the flower centres + 27 for the bead sprigs; strong red and gold sewing thread
- Optional: fabric stiffener (or white PVA glue mixed 1:1 with water) and a blocking mat

## Gauge

> 21 sc and 22 rows = 10 cm (4 in) with the 3.5 mm hook. Gauge decides the size of every piece, so check it. A firm stitch keeps the petals crisp. If your pieces come out bigger, the runner gets wider and you need more yarn.

# Abbreviations & techniques

| | |
|---|---|
| CH | chain |
| SL ST | slip stitch |
| SC | single crochet |
| HDC | half double crochet |
| DC | double crochet |
| DEC | sc2tog: insert in next st, pull up a loop, insert in next st, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through all 3 loops |
| MR | magic ring |
| BLO | back loop only |
| ST(S) / SP | stitch(es) / space |
| PICOT | ch 3, sl st in the 3rd ch from the hook (makes a small bump, not counted as a st) |
| [ ] | stitch count at the end of a round or piece |

## Pieces worked around a chain

All petals, bracts and the dark green leaves are made the same way. **Ch N.** The 2nd ch from the hook is at the **tip**; the last ch (the first one you made) is at the **base**.

**Side A:** work from the 2nd ch from the hook up to the ch before the last ch (N−2 sts). **Base:** 3 sc in the last ch. **Side B:** turn the chain and work the same stitches in reverse order into the free loops on the other side (N−2 sts). Then make the tip and join with a sl st in the first sc.

**Rnd 2** (on the larger pieces) works one stitch into each stitch of Rnd 1 along both sides, adds stitches at the base and makes a pointed picot tip. Working the petals' Rnd 2 in back loops leaves a raised line that outlines the petal like in the photo.

## US and UK terms

This pattern uses US terms. UK: sc = dc, hdc = htr, dc = tr.

## Work smart

Make the pieces in batches, one type at a time. Leave the long tails: you sew with them. Weave in a tail only after the piece is sewn on.

# Part 1 · The pieces

Every piece is made separately. Each flower becomes a "flower group" with its leaves, ferns and berries sewn on the back; the six groups are then sewn onto the spine.

| PIECE | COLOUR | MAKE | SIZE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Spine | Dark green | 1 | 100 × 5 cm |
| Back bract (red flower) | Burgundy | 24 | 11.0 × 4.7 cm |
| Middle bract (red flower) | Red | 24 | 9.1 × 4.7 cm |
| Inner bract (red flower) | Red | 18 | 5.6 × 2.5 cm |
| Rings (red flower) | Burgundy 1 + red 2 per flower | 9 | — |
| Back petal (ivory flower) | Ivory | 24 | 7.2 × 4.7 cm |
| Front petal (ivory flower) | Ivory | 18 | 4.7 × 2.5 cm |
| Rings (ivory flower) | Ivory, 2 per flower | 6 | — |
| Leaf | Dark green | 24 | 8.1 × 3.4 cm |
| Fern | Dark green / olive / gold | 12 / 12 / 18 | 12.3 × 7.3 cm |
| Berry + stem | Red + burgundy | 54 + 18 | 1.8 cm |
| Bead sprig | 3 gold beads | 9 | — |

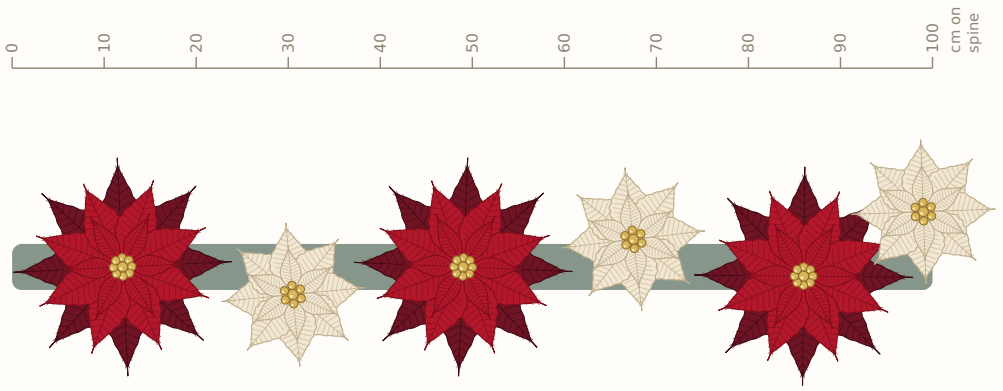



THE GREEN PIECES, BERRIES AND SPRIGS

> Sizes are measured flat after blocking, at the gauge given. The flower order from the top end is red, ivory, red, ivory, red, ivory, with the ivory flowers set a little to the side for the relaxed zig-zag look of the photo.

# Part 2 · The spine

| | |
|---|---|
| COLOUR | Dark green, so it disappears under the leaves. |
| FOUNDATION | Ch 211. |
| ROW 1 | Sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each ch across **[210]**. |
| ROWS 2–11 | Ch 1, turn, sc in each st across **[210]**. |
| FINISH | Fasten off and weave in the ends. Pin it flat to 100 × 5 cm and let it dry. |
| MARK | Mark the flower centres with pins, measured from the top end: red 12 cm; ivory 30.5 cm (3 cm left); red 49 cm; ivory 67.5 cm (3 cm right); red 86 cm (1 cm left); ivory 99 cm (6 cm right). Left and right are seen from the top end. |




FLOWER CENTRES ON THE SPINE (TOP END ON THE LEFT)

> The flowers overlap a little, just like in the photo: each ivory flower sits on the tips of the red bracts next to it. The last ivory flower overlaps the lower right of the third red flower.

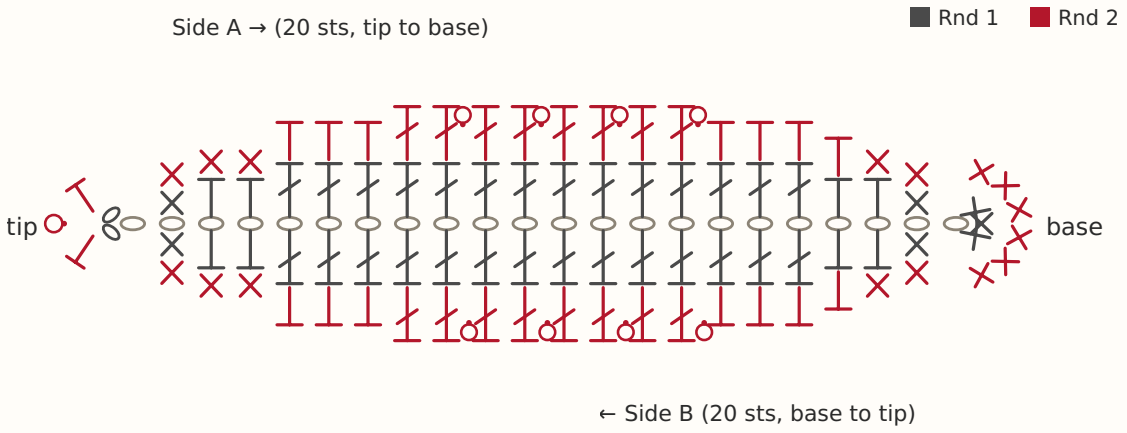
# Part 3 · Red poinsettia (make 3)

Three layers: 8 burgundy back bracts, 8 red middle bracts and 6 small red inner bracts, each layer on its own ring, with 9 gold beads in the centre.

## Back bract · burgundy · make 24

**Rnd 1.** Ch 22. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 14 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[20]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 14 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[20]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[43 sts + ch-2 tip]**

**Rnd 2.** Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 3 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 4 times, hdc in next 4 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[20]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 4 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 4 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 3 sts **[20]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[48 sts + 9 picots]**



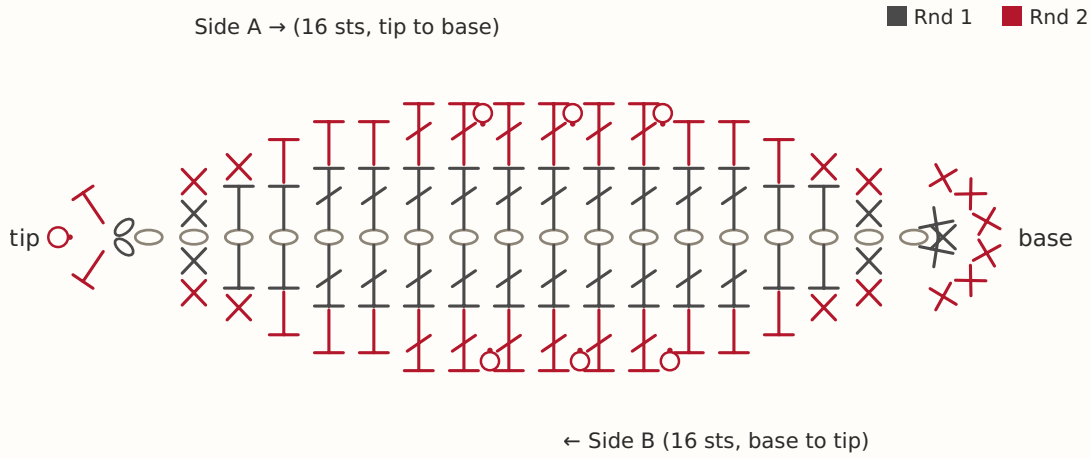

BACK BRACT, RND 1 AND RND 2

# Part 3 · Red poinsettia (continued)

## Middle bract · red · make 24

**Rnd 1.** Ch 18. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 10 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[16]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 10 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[16]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[35 sts + ch-2 tip]**

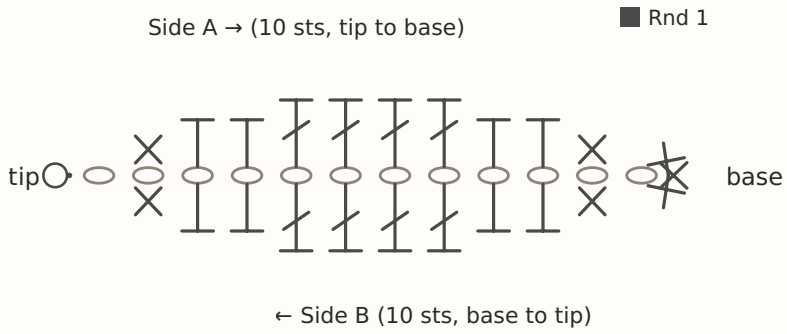
**Rnd 2.** Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 3 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[16]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 3 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[16]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[40 sts + 7 picots]**




MIDDLE BRACT, RND 1 AND RND 2

## Inner bract · red · make 18

**Rnd 1.** Ch 12. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 4 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[10]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 4 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[10]**. Tip: picot (ch 3, sl st in 3rd ch from hook), sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[23 sts + tip picot]**




INNER BRACT (ONE ROUND)

# Part 3 · Red poinsettia (continued)

## Rings · make 1 of each per flower

### BACK RING · BURGUNDY

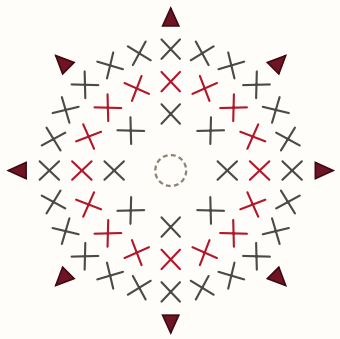
**Rnd 1.** MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. **Rnd 3.** Ch 1, (sc in next st, 2 sc in next st) 8 times, sl st to first sc **[24]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

### MIDDLE RING · RED

**Rnd 1.** MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

### INNER RING · RED

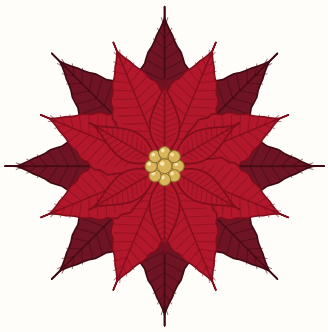
**Rnd 1.** MR, 6 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[6]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[12]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.



BACK RING: ONE BRACT EVERY 3RD ST

## Build the flower

1. Back layer: sew the base of one burgundy bract to every 3rd st of the back ring (8 bracts, evenly spaced). Use the bract's tail and sew through both loops.
2. Middle layer: sew one red middle bract to every 2nd st of the middle ring.
3. Inner layer: sew one inner bract to every 2nd st of the inner ring.
4. Stack the layers: middle on back, inner on middle. Turn each layer so its bracts sit **between** the bracts below. Sew the three rings together through all layers.
5. Centre: sew 9 gold beads to the inner ring: 1 in the middle and 8 in a circle around it, touching.



FINISHED RED FLOWER, ABOUT 25 CM ACROSS



AI preview image

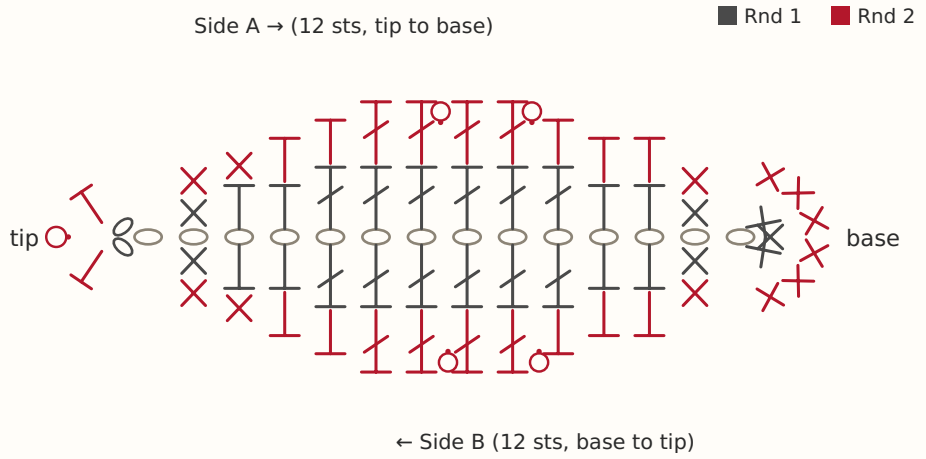
# Part 4 · Ivory poinsettia (make 3)

Two ivory layers: 8 back petals and 6 front petals, with 7 gold beads in the centre.

## Back petal · make 24

**Rnd 1.** Ch 14. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 6 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[12]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 6 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[12]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[27 sts + ch-2 tip]**

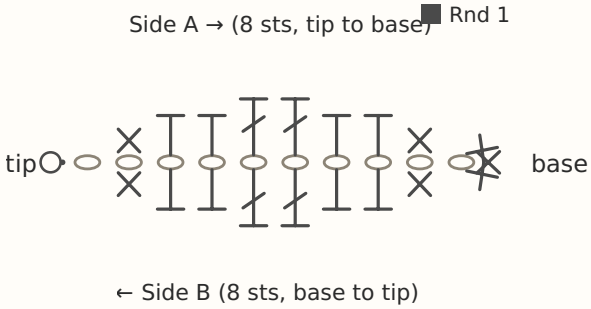
**Rnd 2.** Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 2 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 2 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next st **[12]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next st, hdc in next 3 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 2 times, hdc in next 2 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[12]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[32 sts + 5 picots]**




BACK PETAL, RND 1 AND RND 2

## Front petal · make 18

**Rnd 1.** Ch 10. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 2 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[8]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 2 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[8]**. Tip: picot (ch 3, sl st in 3rd ch from hook), sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[19 sts + tip picot]**




FRONT PETAL (ONE ROUND)

# Part 4 · Ivory poinsettia (continued)

## Rings · make 1 of each per flower

### BACK RING

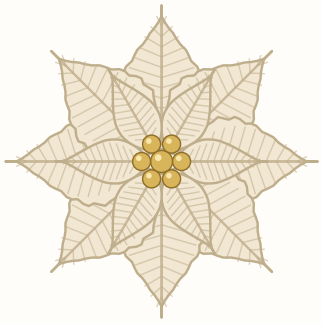
**Rnd 1.** MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

### FRONT RING

**Rnd 1.** MR, 6 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[6]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[12]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

## Build the flower

1. Sew one back petal to every 2nd st of the back ring (8 petals).
2. Sew one front petal to every 2nd st of the front ring (6 petals).
3. Put the front layer on the back layer so the front petals sit between the back petals. Sew the rings together.
4. Centre: sew 7 gold beads: 1 in the middle and 6 around it.



FINISHED IVORY FLOWER, ABOUT 16 CM ACROSS



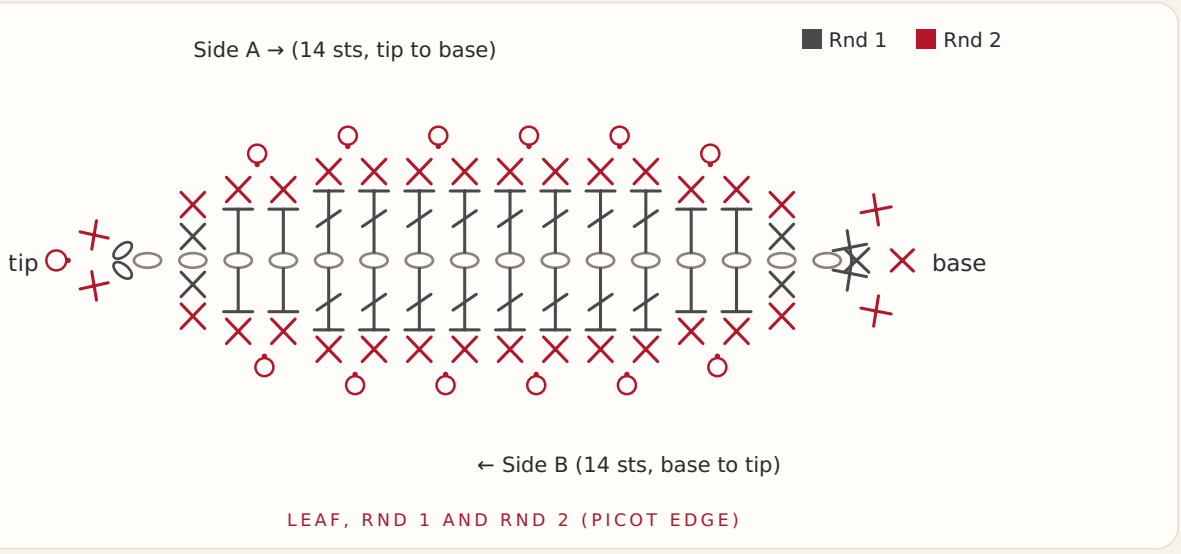
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# Part 5 · Leaves

## Dark green leaf · make 24

**Rnd 1.** Ch 16. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 8 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[14]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 8 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[14]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[31 sts + ch-2 tip]**

**Rnd 2.** Ch 1. In both loops, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: (sc in next 2 sts, picot) 6 times, sc in next 2 sts **[14]**; base: sc in each of next 3 sts **[3]**; Side B: (sc in next 2 sts, picot) 6 times, sc in next 2 sts **[14]**; tip: (sc, picot, sc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[33 sts + 13 picots]**




LEAF, RND 1 AND RND 2 (PICOT EDGE)

> Rnd 2 of the leaf is worked in both loops. The picots give the jagged leaf edge you see in the photo.

# Part 5 · Ferns

The lacy fronds are the same pattern in three colours: 12 dark green, 12 olive and 18 gold.

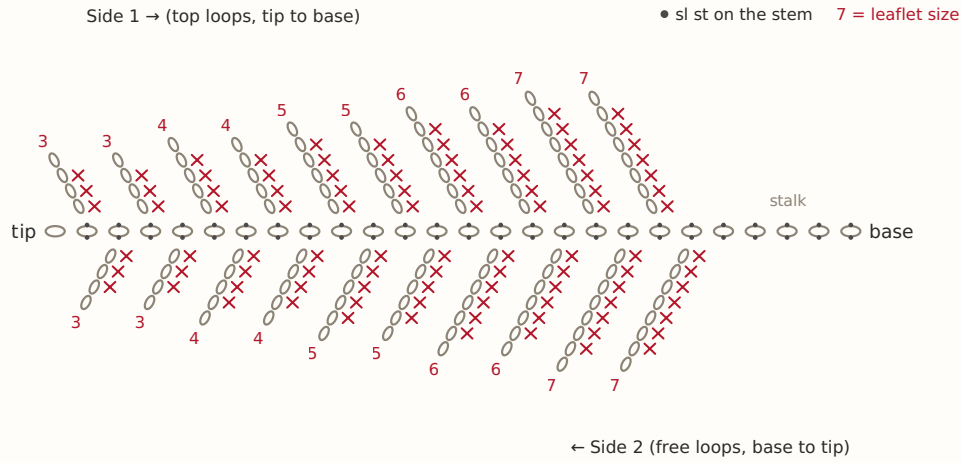
### LEAFLET (SIZE K)

Ch k + 1, sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each of the next k − 1 ch **[k sc]**. You end back at the stem. Example: leaflet 5 = ch 6, sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in the next 4 ch.

### FERN

**Ch 26.** Side 1: sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook (tip). *Make a leaflet, sl st in the next 2 ch*; repeat from * 10 times, with leaflet sizes 3, 3, 4, 4, 5, 5, 6, 6, 7, 7. Sl st in each of the last 4 ch (stalk).

Side 2: turn the work so the free loops of the chain are on top. Sl st in the free loop of each of the first 4 ch. *Sl st in the next 2 ch, make a leaflet*; repeat from * 10 times, with leaflet sizes 7, 7, 6, 6, 5, 5, 4, 4, 3, 3. Sl st in the last ch (tip). Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[20 leaflets, 100 sc]**




FERN: THE LEAFLETS ALTERNATE ALONG THE STEM

> Each fern is about 12.3 cm long and 7.3 cm wide. Pin it flat with the leaflets spread like a feather and spray it with water (or stiffener for the gold ones). Let it dry.

# Part 6 · Berries & bead sprigs

## Berry · red · make 54

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Rnd 1 | MR, 6 sc in the ring | [6] |
| Rnd 2 | 2 sc in each st | [12] |
| Rnd 3 | (sc in next st, ch 1, skip 1 st) 6 times | [6 sc, 6 ch-1 sps] |
| Rnd 4 | (sc in the sc, sc in the ch-1 sp) 6 times | [12] |
| Rnd 5 | dec 6 times | [6] |
| Rnd 6 | dec 3 times | [3] |

Stuff the berry firmly after Rnd 4, using **red yarn scraps**: white stuffing would show through the little holes of Rnd 3. Work Rnds 5 and 6, then close the hole and keep the tail for sewing.

## Stem · burgundy · make 18

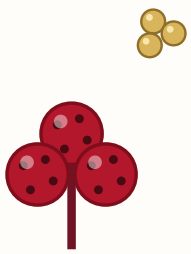
Ch 9, sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each ch across **[8]**. Fasten off, leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail.

## Berry cluster · make 18

Sew 1 berry to the tip of a stem and 1 berry on each side, about 1 cm lower, so the 3 berries touch.

## Bead sprig · make 9

Thread 3 gold beads on strong gold thread and sew them into a small triangle on top of each other. Leave the thread ends for sewing on.



BERRY CLUSTER AND BEAD SPRIG



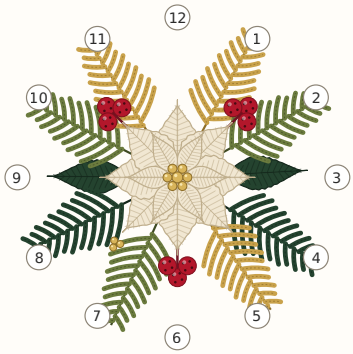
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# Part 7 · Flower groups

Turn each finished flower face down. Twelve o'clock always points to the **top end** of the runner. Sew each green piece on the back of the back-layer petals, at the clock position below, with its tip pointing out. Sew only the bottom 2–3 cm of each piece so the tips stay free.




RED FLOWER GROUP (FRONT VIEW)




IVORY FLOWER GROUP (FRONT VIEW)

## RED FLOWER

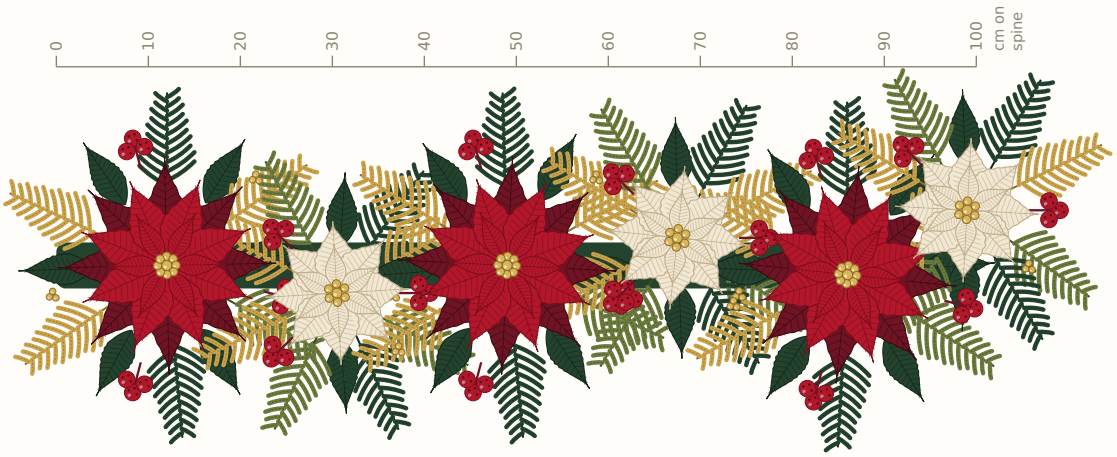
| | |
|---|---|
| LEAVES | 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 o'clock, base 8 cm from the centre |
| DARK GREEN FERNS | 3, 9 o'clock |
| OLIVE FERNS | 7 o'clock |
| GOLD FERNS | 1, 5, 11 o'clock |
| FERNS | base 6.5 cm from the centre |
| BERRY CLUSTERS | 2:30, 6:30, 9:30 o'clock, at the edge of the flower |
| BEAD SPRIGS | 4:30, 11:30 o'clock, on top |

## IVORY FLOWER

| | |
|---|---|
| LEAVES | 3, 9 o'clock, base 5 cm from the centre |
| DARK GREEN FERNS | 4, 8 o'clock |
| OLIVE FERNS | 2, 7, 10 o'clock |
| GOLD FERNS | 1, 5, 11 o'clock |
| FERNS | base 4 cm from the centre |
| BERRY CLUSTERS | 1:30, 6, 10:30 o'clock, at the edge of the flower |
| BEAD SPRIGS | 7:30 o'clock, on top |

# Part 7 · Assembly

1. Block all pieces before you sew (see Part 8): petals, leaves and ferns lie much flatter when they are dry and shaped.
2. Make the six flower groups as shown on the previous page.
3. Lay the spine flat with the marked top end away from you.
4. Place each flower group on its pin, face up, in the order red, ivory, red, ivory, red, ivory. Let the ivory groups overlap the tips of the red bracts next to them.
5. Sew each group to the spine through its rings with small stitches, then tack the overlapping petals, leaves and ferns of neighbouring groups to each other in 2–3 places from the back.
6. Turn the runner over and check that nothing hangs loose. From the front, check that the spine is not visible; tuck an extra leaf or fern where you can still see it.




FINISHED RUNNER, ABOUT 40 × 117 CM (TOP END ON THE LEFT)

# Part 8 · Finishing & care

| | |
|---|---|
| BLOCK | Pin every piece flat on a blocking mat, right side up, and shape the points. Spray with water and let it dry. |
| STIFFEN | For crisp petals, brush thin fabric stiffener on the back of the bracts, petals and gold ferns. Let it dry for 24 hours before you sew. |
| CARE | Spot clean only. Do not machine wash: the stiffener and the beads do not like it. Store flat, or rolled loosely with tissue paper. |
| USE | Use on a dry table. Keep candles and open flames away: cotton burns. |



AI preview image

# Tips for beautiful poinsettias

| | |
|---|---|
| TENSION | Keep the stitches firm. Loose bracts flop; firm bracts stand up. |
| DYE LOTS | Buy all the yarn of one colour at the same time so the shade matches. |
| BATCHES | Make all pieces of one kind before you start the next. It goes faster and they come out the same size. |
| OVERLAP | Let the pieces overlap generously. The runner in the photo looks rich because almost no table shows between the leaves. |
| BEADS | Check that your beads' holes fit your needle and thread before you buy them. |



AI preview image

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